

** This agreement was taken and edited from a UW grad course I took with Bianca Viray

Community Agreement:

[to be edited together]

This course aims to offer a joyful, meaningful, and empowering experience to every participant. You will be both challenged and supported. Each participant will give their available effort to taking an active, critical, patient, and generous role in their own learning and that of their classmates.

Advocating for yourself in a mathematical space:

- Remember: the goal is to improve/deepen skills and understanding. That looks different for each person.
- Some suggested phrases:
 - Can we outline/recap what we just did together? Can we write it down together?
 - Can you please repeat what you just said?
 - Can you please explain the motivation for this definition? I'd like to understand the bigger picture.
 - Can you draw a picture?
 - How do you think about this (that helps you understand)?
 - I'm not talking because I'm thinking about...
 - Can we work out an example for this?
 - Can we write this down or go to the board?
 - I'm not comfortable with the speed we are going at
 - Can I repeat this back so I can check my understanding?
 - I think I need to go back to the definition/previous section/...
 - What do you mean when you say "can you _____ this?" (e.g. compute)
 - I need a few minutes to think on my own before I can frame a question.
 - Can we take a break?
 - If you don't know what to ask, just look confused.

Advocating for others in a mathematical space:

- Pay attention to body language / how much people are speaking / facial expressions
- People can often be more comfortable giving help than asking for help. But if you ask first, they will feel more comfortable asking later!
- Check in with others
- Proceed only after consent (and remember, consent is enthusiastic!)
- Mathematical mistakes are **not** character flaws.
- Model **not** knowing.
- Model wanting to understand more deeply.
- Answer a question only if you were asked directly (i.e., do not jump in to answer for someone else).

- Some suggested phrases:
 - You look skeptical / not convinced. Did I skip a step?
 - I am struggling with XX. Could someone explain to me how they are thinking about this?
 - Great question!
 - You're right!
 - Let me try again.
 - (Before moving on to a new topic) Does anyone have questions or comments?
 - Tell me the place where you stopped following.
 - (On a 1st time reading) A question I would ask is...

General Rules:

- Use the 3-2 rule for participating in groups: try to let 2 people speak after you've spoken before speaking again, and try to speak up if 3 people have spoken since the last time you spoke
- Respect your classmates' pronouns – it's okay to ask if you forget!
- Remember that everyone comes from different backgrounds – mathematical and other – be respectful of this, and don't assume knowledge that you have is knowledge that everyone has
- People work at different paces, and doing math fast does not mean doing math better! Be respectful of different paces, and try to work at a pace that everyone can keep up with
- Phrases to avoid:
 - That was easy/trivial/obvious
 - You *just* do this
 - I learned this in highschool!
 - I finished that problem in "X" amount of time
 - Oh, you were stuck on *that* problem?
 - You're wrong – this is how you do it (remember, many exercises have several correct solutions, and hearing several of them is helpful for everyone)